

IN WILDNESS IS THE PRESERVATION OF THE WORLD

ROMANTICISM, CONSERVATION, AND ECOLOGY

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

Henry David Thoreau (1817–62)

BEFORE

1662 English diarist John Evelyn's work *Sylva*, advocating forest conservation, is presented to the Royal Society.

1789 Gilbert White publishes his *Natural History of Selborne*, inspiring a reaction against "imperial ecology."

AFTER

1872 A bill creating the first US national park, Yellowstone, is signed into law by President Ulysses S. Grant.

1892 In San Francisco, Scottish–American conservationist John Muir founds The Sierra Club.

1971 The UNESCO "Man and the Biosphere" project is launched.

In many ways, Romanticism—a new cultural movement that emerged towards the end of the 18th century—was a reaction to the scientific rationalism of the Enlightenment. As industrialization took hold in urban areas, writers, artists, and composers began increasingly to glorify the